Primary research.

Fifteen hours at the 24-hour open house. Twenty-plus founder conversations. Eight structured interviews on a ten-question script, three fully transcribed — these eight are the ones that matter.

FOUNDER	THE KEY POINT	PAIN #1	TOOLS PAID	WOULD PAY
Shah Rukh Comic universe · 5y GTM	"Distribution is the central nervous system of any founder's journey." AI outreach = 40-50% manpower saved. Founders fail on unclear ICP, wrong channel, no founder brand. GTM consultants now $700-1,000/hr.	Outbound	0	~$200/mo
Sai Karan LazyTyper	"Scripts are the headache" — videos are easy, writing isn't. Launches on Product Hunt, Peerlist, five subreddits, X. Built his own agent (Lara) for X instead of paying for tools. Wants AEO maintained weekly.	Content — scripts	0 · built own	$10-15 (others $100+)
Vihar Dinebees · 10K downloads	Pain: finding the right creators. Happy for AI to draft 20 personal messages — with approval: "in India, public posting needs human review." AEO "very willing" once explained. Max 1-2 subscriptions ever. Signed for a free service month.	Content — creators	0	₹1.5-2K/mo
Sidhant CareKin	Distribution and positioning are his biggest bottleneck. Learned the tools exist from this interview. "I would actually buy it."	Positioning	0	₹2K stated buyer
Stazey founder Airbnb alternative	Loved the content engine. Reddit + LinkedIn posting is the draw — automating it "alone is worth it."	Content — Reddit, LinkedIn	0	₹1.5-3K/mo
Vikas XEO Rank · AEO agency	Expert validation: AEO is monitor-first, ongoing weekly work — not a one-time fix. Add SEO tracking to the optics engine.	Domain expert	Runs agency	—
Prithvi Community founder	"Tools are separate ingredients in a kitchen. Braino is the chef — one dish, no juggling apps." Backs voice-first Jarvis positioning. Human-in-loop is a must.	Tool juggling	0 · knew, never used	₹3K/mo
Eighth Verbal notes	Same pattern — distribution pain, no tools, content-first.	Distribution	0	—

8 / 8	0 / 8	8 / 8	8 / 8	3	₹1,500-3,000
distribution pain	pay for any tool	AEO interest	demand an approval gate	stated buyers	India band, per month

The other twelve-plus conversations.

Every founder shown Braino asked to try it — the 100% trial-interest pattern held. Consensus: GTM is learnable from frameworks, but distribution is "street smartness." Nobody named a tool they pay for. Zero contradicting signal.

Five findings.

Distribution is the pain, 8/8. Zero tools paid for — greenfield; Braino is the founder's first system, not a replacement. Content beats outbound as pain #1. AEO excites everyone, and an expert confirms it's weekly work. Autonomy must be approval-gated — every founder said so.

The union, and the union workflow.

Overlay all eight founders' weeks. Whatever repeats is the union — and the union, wired together, is the machine below.

WEEKLY ACTIVITY	WHO DOES / WANTS IT	IN UNION?
Content creation + posting	7/8 — scripts (Sai), creators (Vihar), Stazey, Prithvi, Shah Rukh's channel flooding	Yes — core
Platform presence — Reddit, LinkedIn, X	6/8 — Sai (X + subreddits, built Lara for X), Stazey (Reddit + LinkedIn), Shah Rukh (Reddit, Discord, FB), Vihar (IG, Reddit planned) + the documented r/buildinpublic grind	Yes — core
AEO / AI visibility	8/8 once explained — Vikas does it professionally	Yes — core
Personalized outreach	4/8 — Shah Rukh (40-50% saving), Sai, Vihar, Sidhant	Yes — gated
Research / listening	3/8 — Sai built Lara for it	Partial — feeds content
Inbound calls / paid ads	0/8 and 2/8 — Vihar called inbound irrelevant	No — cut

Union = content + Reddit/LinkedIn/X presence + AEO + gated outreach → roughly 80% of every founder's distribution week.

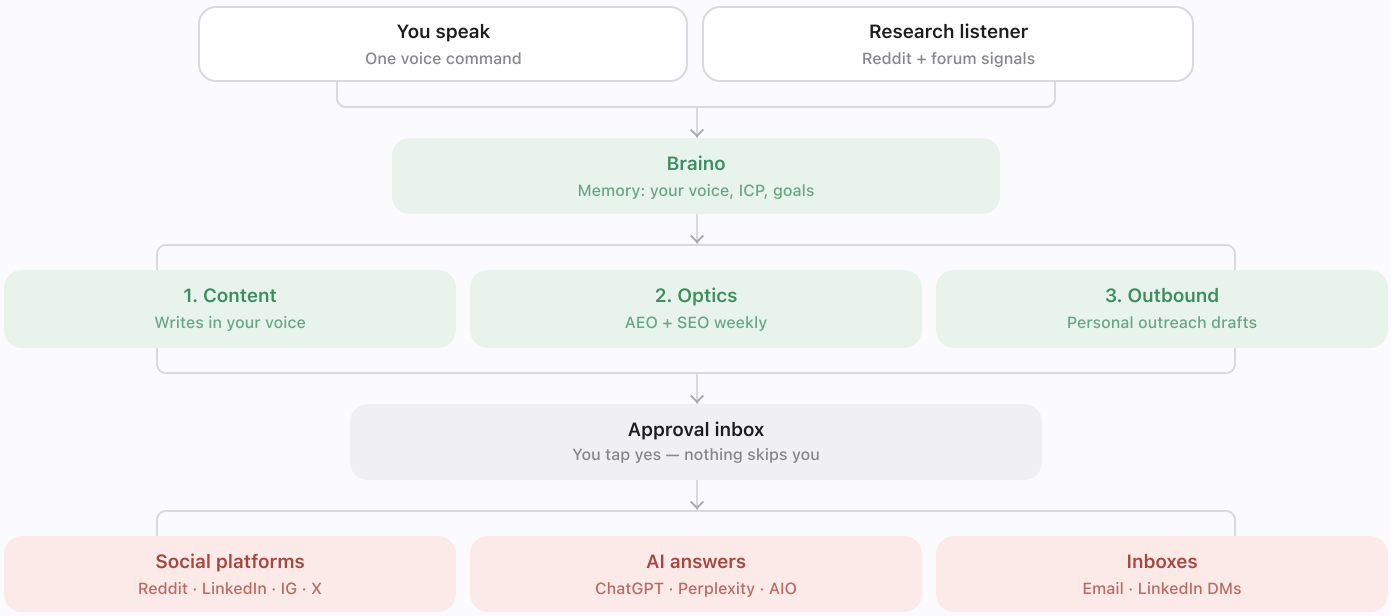
The full machine, and each engine end to end, are drawn on the next page.

The union workflow, drawn.

One machine, then each engine on its own. Same shape every time: something comes in, Braino works, **you approve, and only then does anything reach the public.**

The full machine

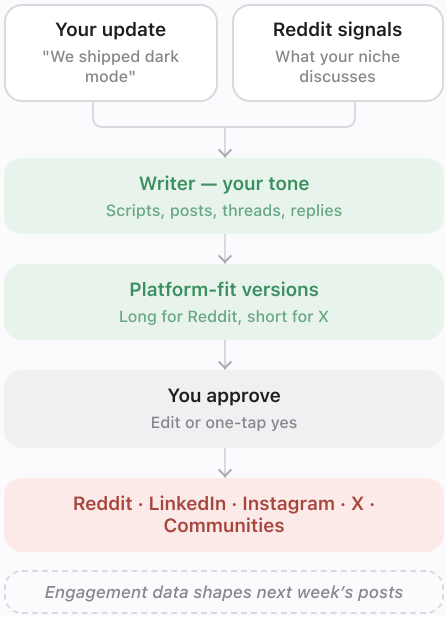
Chef metaphor (Prithvi) · approval inbox 8/8 · engines = union



Each engine, end to end

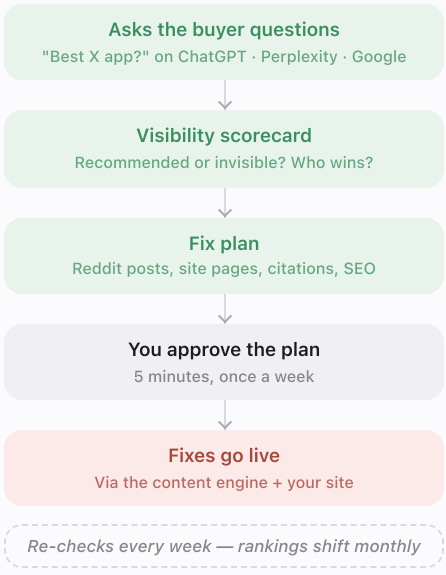
Engine 1 — Content

Scripts (Sai) · creators (Vihar) · Reddit + LinkedIn (Stazey) · X (Sai)



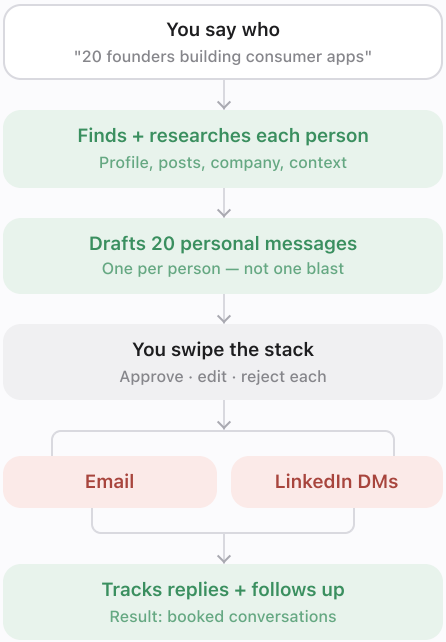
Engine 2 — Optics, AEO + SEO

Weekly monitor-first (Vikas) · citations churn ~23%/mo



Engine 3 — Outbound

40-50% saving (Shah Rukh) · email + LinkedIn DMs · gate 8/8



Secondary research, and the competition.

What the internet confirms — every claim sourced — and why nobody occupies Braino's seat.

Building is solved. Distribution is the bottleneck.

- 1 in 3 new companies in 2026 is founded by one person — AI cut dev cost ~90% and time-to-MVP ~60%. (Solo Founder Playbook 2026)
- A Product Hunt Top-5 finish now brings ~1,500 visits, not 15,000. The old launch playbook is dead.
- A VC analysis of founder forums found ONE recurring theme: distribution — not AI, not features. (FundnAI)
- The "Distribution Chasm": months of building, then launch to silence — five waitlist signups. (Before Takeoff)

The manual grind, quantified.

- Documented case: 2+ hours daily on Reddit for six months → only 2-3 usable opportunities a week. (r/buildinpublic via VibeCom)
- That's ~10 hours of grinding per handful of real conversations — across Reddit, LinkedIn and X alike.
- Value-first posts earn ~10x the engagement of promotional ones. It works — but eats time founders don't have.

The AEO shift.

- 37% of product discovery now STARTS in AI interfaces like ChatGPT and Perplexity. (Profound)
- ChatGPT referrals convert at 14-16% vs ~1.8% for Google organic — roughly 9x. (Omnibound)
- Only 18% of brands have any AI-visibility strategy — 82% are invisible by default. (Erlin, 200+ marketing leaders)
- Citations churn ~23%/month; only ~30% of brands stay visible answer-to-answer — weekly maintenance is mandatory, which makes it recurring revenue. (AirOps)
- Reddit is ~10% of AI citations; brand websites only 5-10% — multi-platform content does double duty: community reach AND AI visibility. (Semrush, 100M citations)

Competition, scored.

PLAYER	CONTENT	AEO	OUTBOUND	INBOUND	DONE-FOR-YOU	PRICE
Lovable code gen	—	—	—	—	—	$25+
Leapd "AI cofounder"	Yes	Yes	Yes	—	—	$299-999
AgentWeb	Yes	Partial	Partial	—	—	$299
Apollo + Clay	—	—	Strong	—	—	$50-100
Peec / Profound	—	Measure only	—	—	—	$99-399
Buffer / Postiz	Schedule only	—	—	—	—	$15-49
GTM consultants	Yes	Some	Yes	Some	Yes — human	$700-1,000/hr
Braino	**Yes**	**Fixes weekly**	**Gated**	**Deferred — 0/8**	**Yes — agent + FDE**	**₹1.5K-$200/mo**

Every software player sits in "you do the work." Only human consultants are done-for-you — at $700+/hr. Full-stack, done-for-you, founder-priced is an empty quadrant. That's Braino's seat.

Hands-on trial (per Bhaskar): trying Apollo, Buffer, Retell as a user today — friction notes to follow.

The open-source blueprint, and what it all means.

The union workflow mapped to a stack we can wire this month — then the synthesis and the price.

JOB	THE AGENT DOES	OPEN-SOURCE / STACK	WHEN
Glue / orchestration	Routes tasks, schedules runs, holds the approval queue	n8n (self-hosted, OSS) spine + LLM API brain	First
Content	Writes in the founder's tone; platform-fit versions for Reddit, LinkedIn, X, IG	LLM writer + Postiz (OSS scheduler) for LinkedIn/X/IG; Reddit via PRAW	Wk 1-2
Research feed	Listens for niche keywords, surfaces threads worth joining	Reddit API keyword listeners, F5Bot-style, self-built	Wk 1-2
Optics — AEO + SEO	Weekly buyer-question checks, scorecard, fix drafts	Scheduled LLM queries + OSS SERP scrapers; fixes ship via content engine	Wk 3-4
Outbound	Researches targets, drafts 1:1 messages, tracks replies	Lead scrapers / Apollo free tier + LLM personalization + SMTP; LinkedIn DMs assisted	Wk 5-6
Approval layer	One inbox — approve, edit, reject; nothing posts without it	n8n wait-nodes + Braino app: voice in, tap out	Ships with v1
Inbound	AI calls and chat	Retell / Bland class	Deferred — 0/8 asked

This exact wiring runs by hand for Dinebees first — **free service month, signed** *— then we productize what repeats. Cost stays near zero through the service phase.*

Synthesis.

Founders can build in days but can't distribute. They pay for zero tools — existing tools serve marketers with budgets, not pre-revenue founders. So they grind manually across Reddit, LinkedIn and X, or launch to silence, while discovery moves to AI answers and 82% of brands have no strategy for it. **The white space: be the founder's first distribution system** — one voice-commanded companion that writes in their tone, keeps them visible in AI answers weekly, and drafts personal outreach. Every action approval-gated. Priced for pre-revenue.

Pricing, anchored to stated numbers.

TIER	PRICE	ANCHOR
India pre-revenue starter	₹1,499-2,999/mo	CareKin ₹2K · Stazey ₹1.5-3K · Prithvi ₹3K · Vihar ₹1.5-2K
Global solo-founder Pro	$49-99/mo	"A normal founder would pay $100+" — Sai Karan
Revenue-stage / GTM	$200+/mo	Shah Rukh's ceiling; consultants at $700-1,000/hr
FDE service — run it for you	Free month → ₹25-50K/mo	Dinebees signed; YC 2026: "sell the service"

Founders don't need another tool — they have none. They need one companion that does content, visibility, and outreach for them, with their approval, at a price they can say yes to before revenue. That's Braino Foundry.